

Creating Data Inputs

- We will need to add **Data inputs** in order for the logs to populate in our dashboards. So we will go to Settings > Data > Data Inputs > Select **Add New** for the **Files & Directory** type

Add Data

Select Source | Set Source Type | Input Settings | Review | Done

Files & Directories
Upload a file, index a local file, or monitor an entire directory.

HTTP Event Collector
Configure tokens that clients can use to send data over HTTP or HTTPS.

TCP / UDP
Configure the Splunk platform to listen on a network port.

Scripts
Get data from any API, service, or database with a script.

checkapp

Configure this instance to monitor files and directories for data. To monitor all objects in a directory, select the directory. The Splunk platform monitors and assigns a single source type to all objects within the directory. This might cause problems if there are different object types or data sources in the directory. To assign multiple source types to objects in the same directory, configure individual data inputs for those objects. [Learn More](#)

File or Directory:

On Windows: c:\apache\apache.error.log or \hostname\apache\apache.error.log. On Unix: /var/log or /mnt/www01/var/log.

Using the `/var/log/auth.log` file as an example

Add Data

Select Source | **Set Source Type** | Input Settings | Review

Set Source Type

This page lets you see how the Splunk platform sees your data before indexing. If the events look correct and have the right "Next" to proceed. If not, use the options below to define proper event breaks and timestamps. If you cannot find an app for your data, create a new one by clicking "Save As".

Source: `/var/log/auth.log`

Source type: `linux_secure`

	Time	Event
1	7/12/26 12:17:01.000 AM	Jul 12 00:17:01 sh (uid=0) by (uid=0)
2	7/12/26 12:17:01.000 AM	Jul 12 00:17:01 sh
3	7/12/26 1:17:01.000 AM	Jul 12 01:17:01 sh (uid=0) by (uid=0)
4	7/12/26 1:17:01.000 AM	Jul 12 01:17:01 sh

For this file, I had to change the source type to `linux_secure` before I could continue